

How to add **subscriptions** to HooknLoop

What to offer, which customers it suits, and the exact facilities to give them – written to be understood by anyone, not just developers.

Auto-reorder & standing orders

What to build first

Australian rules included

No jargon

START HERE

01 The one big idea

For a tape business, a “subscription” is **not** a discount club like Netflix. It’s a way to help the customers who buy the same tape again and again **never run out – automatically**. The whole strategy depends on one thing: knowing **who that is**. Your customers split cleanly into two groups.

✓ GREAT FIT – OFFER IT

Repeat buyers

Businesses that get through hook & loop as a constant supply:

- ✓ Factories & manufacturers (OEMs)
- ✓ Upholsterers, sign-makers, marine & auto trimmers
- ✓ Events, AV & IT teams (cable management)

They reorder the same rolls month after month. What they want isn’t a discount – it’s to **never run out**, have stock **reserved**, and **skip the repeat paperwork**.

- NOT A FIT – DON'T PUSH

One-off buyers

People buying for a single job:

- DIY & hobby customers
- Schools & makerspaces (buy once a term)
- Anyone buying for one project

Forcing them into an auto-delivery just leads to **cancellations and refunds**. Give them a fast **“Reorder” button** instead – not a subscription.

WHY ANYONE SUBSCRIBES

02 What you’re really selling

Customers don’t sign up to save 5%. They sign up for **peace of mind**. These are the four things genuinely worth paying for – lead your offer with these, not with a discount.



Never run out

Stock arrives on schedule, before they hit empty. No emergency orders.



Ships first

Subscriber orders are picked and dispatched ahead of the queue, with stock set aside.



Price locked

The price stays fixed for the term. No surprises when materials move.



Less admin

One regular delivery and one GST invoice – instead of re-typing the same order every month.

03 The plans to offer

Offer a small ladder – from a no-commitment reorder button up to fully managed stock. Most customers will live on the first three rungs. You don’t need to build all five at once (see the rollout in §7).

Rung 1 · Free Easy Reorder For everyone	A “Buy again” button on every past order, saved shopping lists, and a friendly email when they’re probably running low. No commitment, no card saved. This alone wins back a lot of repeat business – and it’s the cheapest thing to build.
Rung 2 · 5% off Auto-Restock For repeat buyers & small shops	On standard rolls, dots and straps, the customer picks a schedule – say every 4, 8 or 12 weeks – and it ships automatically for a small 5% thank-you. They can skip, pause, change the quantity or cancel anytime . (Sometimes called “Subscribe & Save”.)
★ YOUR BIGGEST OPPORTUNITY Rung 3 · No discount needed Standing Order For trade & business accounts	Agree a regular basket of their staple items on a set schedule. You reserve their stock, ship it first , and send one invoice on account (pay later). No discount required – they’re paying for certainty and less hassle. This is where most of the money is.
Rung 4 · Yearly fee Trade+ Membership Optional, for regular trade	A yearly fee (say \$99-199) that unlocks free freight, priority cut-to-length, locked prices and reserved stock. The fee is almost pure profit – but only offer it if the perks are genuinely extra . Don’t charge for a discount you already give away free, or it reads as a price rise.
Rung 5 · Later Managed Stock Your top few accounts	For your biggest accounts: you track how fast they use tape and top them up automatically to agreed levels, so their production line never stops. Start by doing this by hand for 3-5 accounts before building any software.

PUT THE RIGHT PRODUCTS ON IT

04 Which products to offer it on

Subscriptions only work on products people buy **over and over in a standard size**. Put your steady sellers on it; leave one-off and custom items off – they’ll just cause cancellations and refunds.

✓ Offer subscriptions on these ✓ Self-adhesive rolls in standard sizes (e.g. 25 / 50 mm × 25 m) ✓ Sew-on tape by the standard roll ✓ Reusable cable straps & self-gripping ties (bulk packs) ✓ Pre-cut dots & coins (bulk packs) ✓ Double-sided mounting tape	✗ Keep these off subscriptions ✗ Heavy-duty ratchet / single-install straps (bought once) ✗ Large fire-retardant rolls (expensive, project-driven) ✗ Premium genuine VELCRO® one-offs ✗ Cut-to-length / custom widths (see warning) ✗ Anything bought for a single DIY project
⚠ The one rule that really matters: don’t offer subscriptions on cut-to-length. A custom cut isn’t a fixed product, so it can’t repeat cleanly – the system will mis-pick and mis-price it. Only offer auto-delivery on standard, off-the-shelf sizes. (Also worth doing: tag your adhesive rolls with their batch so you never auto-ship aged stock or a changed grade to a factory that qualified the old one.)	

05 The facilities to give customers

Here’s the actual feature list, in plain terms, grouped by **who uses it**. Each line is written as “what the customer can do”. The first group alone is worth shipping on its own.

GROUP A For everyone – the foundation	
Reorder button One tap to buy a past order again, at the exact same spec.	Saved lists Save “my usual order” and reorder the whole lot in one go.
“Running low?” reminders An email around when they usually reorder, with a pre-filled cart.	Automatic GST tax invoice A compliant invoice on every order and every renewal – no manual work.
Easy pause & cancel Stop or hold anytime in one click – required by law (see §9).	
GROUP B For repeat buyers – Auto-Restock	
Subscribe & Save toggle On the product page: choose how often it ships (standard sizes only).	Self-serve delivery manager Change the date, quantity or address, or skip the next delivery – no emails.
Card auto-retry If a card expires or fails, it retries and prompts an update – plans don’t silently die.	Priority dispatch & reserved stock Subscriber orders ship first and their stock is set aside.
GROUP C For business accounts – trade	
Order on account (pay later) Approved trade customers get an invoice on net-30 terms instead of paying by card.	Purchase-order number field So their accounts team can match the order to their own PO.
Company pricing & multiple buyers Agreed prices, with several people ordering under one account.	Standing-order builder + price lock Set a recurring basket & schedule, and hold a fixed price for 6-12 months.

06 Make subscribing the easy choice

You don’t need to **convince** people – most rebuy anyway. The job is to make **“keep it coming”** the easy, obvious, safe choice at the exact moment they’re already buying. Do it with **convenience and certainty, not deep discounts**. These extra facilities do exactly that.



THE SINGLE BEST THING TO ADD FIRST

One line of grey text right under the **Subscribe** button: **“Skip, pause or cancel anytime – no lock-in, no minimum.”** It’s free (just words), takes minutes, and removes the number-one reason a tradie clicks “buy once” – the fear of being stuck with deliveries they can’t stop.

The 5 easiest wins

FACILITY · WHAT THE CUSTOMER SEES		WHY IT MAKES THEM SUBSCRIBE	BUILD
1	“No lock-in” line on the button A small line under Subscribe: “Skip, pause or cancel anytime.”	Kills the “am I trapped?” fear at the exact click that stops them. Costs nothing.	Easy
2	Subscribe pre-selected, timing pre-filled Subscribe is already chosen and “how often” is pre-set to a sensible guess. One-time sits right beside it.	Removes the two decisions that stall people – <i>should I?</i> and <i>how often?</i> Biggest proven lift of any change here.	Easy
3	“Make it automatic” on the thank-you page After they pay: “Turn this order into auto-restock and save 5% – one tap, nothing to re-enter.”	They’ve already bought; card & address are saved. Catches the buyer who ignored the button on the product page.	Easy
4	Show real dollars + time saved “Save about \$47/year on this roll – and skip re-ordering every month.”	“\$47 and no admin” beats “5%”. Just computed text – no extra discount. (Only show it when the saving is real.)	Easy
5	“Set to auto” in their order history Beside “Reorder,” a second button: “Reorder + keep it coming.” Pushed on the 3rd repeat.	Aimed at people who’ve proven they rebuy – right as they do it by hand again. The strongest possible signal.	Easy

Why these work (real numbers): pre-selecting subscribe lifted sign-ups 11-176% in tests · a post-purchase offer converts 3-5× the on-page button · “about to run out” emails convert ~8-15% vs 1-3% for normal promos. *(Most were measured at 10-15% off; at your 5% expect the lower end – which is fine, because your real lever is convenience, not price.)*

A few more, grouped

MAKE IT ONE TAP

- A whole-cart **“make this order recurring”** toggle at checkout.
- **No account needed** – manage skip/pause/cancel through a secure emailed link, no password.
- A **QR code on the delivery box**: “Running low? Reorder in one tap.”

REMOVE THE FEAR · your real engine

- A **“what happens next” panel** before they confirm (first ship date, GST invoice each time, reminder before every charge).
- Show the **exact next-charge date** + a one-tap skip in every email.
- A **“it’ll hold or we’ll fix it” first-roll guarantee** – answers the real worry (“will it stick?”), not price.
- A **true** social-proof line: “1,200+ AU workshops restock on auto.”

GIVE A REASON TO START · margin-safe

- A deeper discount on the **first delivery only** (e.g. 15% once) – require a 2-delivery minimum.
- A small **free extra in the first box** – a VELCRO dot pack or strap sampler.
- **Free AU shipping** for subscribers above a set order value (threshold-gate it).

CATCH THE RIGHT MOMENT

- A **predicted run-out email**: “Reorder in one tap – or set it to auto.” (Steady buyers only.)
- A **post-delivery nudge**: “Happy with it? Set it to auto.”
- Add a **“switch to auto”** button to the “running low” reminder you already send.

FOR TRADE ACCOUNTS · the core of the business – sell “less admin + more certainty,” never “cheaper”

- **“Turn my last order into a standing order”** – one tap that keeps their exact cut length & colour. Your most defensible idea: Amazon can’t copy cut-to-length.
- **Blanket PO on file** – one purchase-order number covers every delivery.
- **One combined month-end invoice** instead of one per delivery – less work for their accounts team.
- **Guaranteed stock** so an OEM’s line never stops – beats any discount.
- A **friendly rep note after 3 repeat orders**, offering to set it up – framed as removing admin, not selling.
- A self-serve **“Request a standing order”** form with one-page sign-off.

Skip these – not worth it for a tape store

✗ SMS keyword “text to subscribe”	Most complex to build for the shakiest payoff – the box QR code does the same job far cheaper.
✗ Loyalty points multiplier (3× points)	Abstract points mean nothing to trade buyers. If you want a giveback, use plain store credit shown in dollars.
✗ Prepaid “buy 5 get 1 free”	That’s a ~16% discount – it breaks your shallow-discount rule. Use price-lock + standing orders to hold volume buyers.
✗ Gamified “status ladder” progress bar	Trade buyers ignore it. Just attach the perks that matter (priority queue, price-lock) to your Trade+ tier.

**THE GOLDEN RULE**
Sell certainty and simplicity – not cheapness. Every reason to subscribe should be “less hassle,” “never run out,” or “a price you can count on”; the 5% is a bonus, never the headline. Keep the one-time option just as visible, spell out the terms before they confirm, and make cancelling genuinely one or two taps – in Australia that easy-out is both the law *and* the very thing that makes people comfortable saying yes.

DON'T BUILD IT ALL AT ONCE

07 How to roll it out

Three steps. Start cheap, prove people want it, then layer on the business features. On Shopify you can begin with the **built-in subscriptions** for free before paying for a specialist app.

1

Start small
A FEW WEEKS

Turn on the reorder button, saved lists, running-low reminders and GST invoices. Add Subscribe & Save to **6-10 best-selling standard items**. Phone your top accounts and set up standing orders by hand.

Tools: Shopify Subscriptions (built-in, free) · Klaviyo for reminders · a GST-invoice app

2

Add business accounts
ONCE SUBS ARE WORKING

Add trade accounts (pay-later, PO numbers, company pricing), the standing-order builder and price locks. Move to a dedicated subscriptions app for more control.

Tools: Loop Subscriptions · Shopify B2B / a B2B app for trade accounts

3

Managed stock
LATER, TOP ACCOUNTS ONLY

Hand-manage automatic top-ups for your **3-5 biggest accounts** against agreed stock levels. Only build software for it once it’s clearly working and they’re sticking.

Tools: a spreadsheet first – custom portal only if an account demands it

KEEP THE PROFIT

08 The money side, kept simple

Three things protect your profit. The headline: **lead with certainty, not with discounts** – big discounts just give away margin you don’t need to.

Keep discounts small (5% cap).

Businesses subscribe to avoid running out, not to save a few dollars. Every extra % off comes straight out of profit.

The membership fee is almost pure profit.

A \$149/year fee is money in the door before you ship a single roll – if the perks are genuinely extra.

Planned deliveries save you money.

Turning 4 scattered parcels into 1 scheduled shipment cuts packing & freight a lot – often **more than the small discount costs you**.

WHAT A DISCOUNT REALLY COSTS – A \$100 ROLL THAT COSTS YOU \$40

DISCOUNT	YOU KEEP	PROFIT LOST
0%	\$60	–
5% (our cap)	\$55	~8%
15%	\$45	~25%
25% (typical “sub & save”)	\$35	~42%

A deep discount can wipe out nearly half your profit on your *best*, most loyal customers – the exact people who’d reorder anyway.

09 The rules to follow

Australia is tightening the rules on subscriptions, with **big fines** and new “easy-cancel” laws landing in 2027. None of it is hard – build it in from day one and you’re safe.

- ☐ **Make cancelling as easy as signing up.** One click, self-serve, no phone calls, no maze.
- ☐ **Remind before every charge.** Email 3-5 days ahead showing the date, the amount (inc. GST) and what’s shipping.
- ☐ **Send a GST tax invoice every time.** Each delivery is its own taxable sale – test one full renewal end-to-end.
- ☐ **No tricks.** No pre-ticked auto-renewal boxes, no hidden renewals, no “are you sure?” funnel to escape.
- ☐ **No lock-in.** Month-to-month, cancel anytime, no exit fee; only change a price with notice and a chance to cancel.
- ☐ **Keep normal refund rights.** A subscription never removes a customer’s consumer guarantees.

KNOW IF IT’S WORKING

10 What to watch

A handful of simple numbers tell you whether the program is healthy. Judge it on **profit and repeat behaviour**, not on a vanity “subscriber count”.

Take-up

How many customers use it – aim for a good share of your *repeat* buyers, close to zero of your one-off buyers.

Cancellations – and why

Track the reason. “Too much stock” means fix the schedule, not hand out a coupon.

Too much or too little?

The #1 reason people quit is getting more than they can use. Match the schedule to how fast they actually go through it.

Spend over time

A subscribed repeat buyer should be worth roughly **3-4x** a one-off buyer over a few years.

DO THESE THREE FIRST

If you only do one thing

- 1. Ship the reorder rails** – a “Buy again” button, saved lists and running-low reminders. No discount, big return.
- 2. Add Subscribe & Save** to your 6-10 top standard sellers, at 5%.
- 3. Phone your top 15-20 trade accounts** and set up standing orders by hand.

These three need almost no discounting, break none of the rules, and capture most of the prize – the repeat business hiding in your biggest accounts.